

Geopolitical Fora Amenable to Predictive Modelling

AI Ideation Run

Date: 2026-04-12

Ideas: 20

Depth: Standard

United Nations Security Council (UNSC)

The premier international security body with 15 members, permanent-member veto mechanics, and decades of publicly documented voting records.

The UNSC is arguably the most modelable high-stakes geopolitical body in existence. It has exactly 15 members at any given time – five permanent members (P5) with veto power and ten rotating non-permanent members elected for two-year terms. Every substantive resolution requires nine affirmative votes and no P5 veto. Procedural votes require nine affirmative votes without veto application.

What makes the UNSC exceptionally tractable for AI simulation is the combination of a small, fixed membership with crystal-clear voting rules and an enormous historical dataset. Every vote since 1946 is publicly recorded, including explanations of vote. The veto mechanic creates a binary constraint that dramatically narrows the outcome space – any simulation engine can immediately prune branches where a P5 member signals opposition. Position papers, statements, and draft resolutions are routinely circulated in advance.

The rotating membership does introduce calibration complexity, but the ten elected seats tend to follow regional-group patterns that are themselves predictable. Assigning AI agents to each member state with historically-calibrated policy positions and alliance weights is straightforward, and the procedural constraints make outcome enumeration computationally feasible.

Category: International Security / Multilateral Governance

Feasibility: High — Comprehensive voting records, well-defined veto mechanics, small membership, extensive academic literature on voting patterns.

Impact: High — UNSC decisions directly affect sanctions, peacekeeping operations, and use-of-force authorizations globally.

Key Considerations:

- Behind-the-scenes negotiations (penholding, informal consultations) are not captured in public records
- Veto threats that prevent votes from being called are a major source of hidden influence
- P5 positions are often shaped by bilateral relationships outside the UNSC context
- Draft resolution language is frequently negotiated to avoid vetoes, creating a selection bias in the observable record

Next Steps: Build a historical voting database from UN Digital Library records; calibrate P5 agent positions using foreign ministry statements and prior veto patterns; model the veto-threat dynamic as a pre-vote filtering stage.

OPEC+ Ministerial Conference

A cartel of roughly 23 oil-producing nations that makes quantified production quota decisions through a well-documented consensus process.

OPEC+ combines the 13 OPEC members with approximately 10 non-OPEC partners (the “+” group) to coordinate oil production levels. What makes this body uniquely modelable is that its decisions are fundamentally quantitative – production quotas in barrels per day – and the key variables driving each member’s position are measurable: fiscal breakeven oil price, production capacity, spare capacity, GDP dependence on oil revenue, and current compliance rates.

The decision-making process follows a predictable calendar of ministerial meetings (typically every few months) with a Joint Ministerial Monitoring Committee (JMMC) that prepares recommendations. Decisions are nominally by consensus, but in practice Saudi Arabia and Russia hold dominant influence as the two largest producers. The observable compliance data (actual production vs. quota) provides a continuous feedback signal for calibrating how seriously each member treats its commitments.

Historical production data, quota assignments, and meeting outcomes are publicly available going back decades. The economic incentive structure for each member is relatively transparent – each country’s budget depends on oil revenue in well-documented ways. This makes OPEC+ one of the few geopolitical bodies where agent utility functions can be grounded in hard economic data rather than inferred from rhetoric.

Category: Energy / Economic Coordination

Feasibility: **High** — Quantitative decisions, measurable economic incentives, regular meeting cadence, extensive historical data.

Impact: **High** — Production decisions directly move global oil prices, affecting inflation, trade balances, and geopolitical leverage worldwide.

Key Considerations:

- Saudi Arabia’s willingness to act as swing producer introduces a dominant-actor dynamic
- Compliance cheating is endemic and difficult to model deterministically
- Geopolitical side-deals (e.g., US-Saudi security arrangements) influence positions in ways not captured by economic models alone
- The “+” partners have varying commitment levels to the framework

Next Steps: Construct per-member fiscal models linking oil price to budget balance; build a compliance prediction layer using historical quota vs. actual production; simulate Saudi swing-producer strategies as a separate decision layer.

Basel Committee on Banking Supervision (BCBS)

A 28-member committee of central bank governors and supervisory authorities that sets global banking standards through consensus-based deliberation.

The Basel Committee comprises representatives from 28 jurisdictions and operates by consensus to produce banking regulation standards (Basel I, II, III, and the ongoing Basel 3.1/Endgame framework). While its outputs are technically non-binding, they function as de facto global standards because national regulators almost universally adopt them. The committee’s membership is

fixed, its mandate is narrow (banking prudential standards), and its deliberative process follows a structured cycle of consultation papers, quantitative impact studies, and final standards.

The modelability of the BCBS stems from several factors. Each member's position can be substantially predicted from their domestic banking sector structure – jurisdictions with large, internationally active banks (US, UK, EU) tend to resist capital increases, while those with smaller banking sectors may favor stricter standards. The quantitative impact studies (QIS) that precede every major decision provide hard data on how proposed rules would affect each jurisdiction's banks, making it possible to estimate each member's cost-benefit calculation.

The consensus requirement means that outlier positions must be accommodated, and the historical pattern of Basel negotiations shows consistent dynamics: large banking centers push for flexibility, smaller jurisdictions push for simplicity, and the final standard reflects a compromise. This makes the negotiation space relatively low-dimensional compared to general foreign policy bodies.

Category: Financial Regulation / Standard-Setting

Feasibility: High — Narrow mandate, quantifiable impacts via QIS data, consensus-based process, positions predictable from banking sector structure.

Impact: Medium — Standards shape global banking regulation but implementation is national and often delayed or modified.

Key Considerations:

- The EU often negotiates as a bloc, reducing effective membership for modelling purposes
- Technical complexity of standards means domain expertise is required to model positions accurately
- Implementation timelines and national deviations from Basel standards are a separate modelling challenge
- Industry lobbying influences national positions in ways that may not be publicly visible

Next Steps: Map each member jurisdiction's banking sector profile (concentration, international exposure, capital ratios); analyze QIS response data to calibrate position predictions; model the consensus-building process as iterative position adjustment.

International Whaling Commission (IWC)

A 88-member body with simple majority voting, transparent bloc dynamics, and a decades-long binary policy dispute that makes voting patterns highly predictable.

The IWC is a surprisingly excellent candidate for predictive modelling despite its large membership because the politics reduce to a single dominant axis: pro-whaling versus anti-whaling. This one-dimensional policy space means that each member's position can be encoded as a single variable, and voting outcomes can be predicted by counting bloc sizes. The IWC uses simple majority voting for most decisions and three-quarters majority for schedule amendments (which include catch quotas).

The body has a well-documented history of “vote-buying” by Japan through overseas development assistance to small island states, creating a dynamic where membership composition itself is a

strategic variable. This adds a fascinating meta-layer to the model: predicting which states will join or leave the IWC as a function of Japanese aid flows and anti-whaling diplomatic pressure. The IWC's published voting records are complete and unambiguous, and each country's position is generally stable and publicly stated.

The simplicity of the policy space, combined with transparent bloc membership and clear voting rules, makes the IWC an ideal testbed for multi-agent simulation – not because its decisions are globally important, but because the system is tractable enough to validate modelling approaches before applying them to more complex bodies.

Category: Environmental Governance / International Organization

Feasibility: **High** — One-dimensional policy space, complete voting records, stable bloc membership, transparent influence dynamics.

Impact: **Low** — Limited to whaling policy, but high value as a validation testbed for modelling methodologies.

Key Considerations:

- Japan's 2019 withdrawal from the IWC significantly changed dynamics
- Small-state recruitment by both blocs makes membership endogenous to the model
- The moratorium on commercial whaling means most votes are about maintaining or lifting the status quo
- Aboriginal subsistence whaling creates a cross-cutting issue that complicates the simple binary framing

Next Steps: Build a complete historical voting matrix from IWC records; construct a bloc-membership prediction model using ODA flows and diplomatic indicators; use the IWC as a benchmark for validating multi-agent simulation frameworks.

European Council (EU Heads of State)

The 27-member supreme political body of the EU with qualified majority voting rules that create precise, calculable winning coalitions.

The European Council, comprising the heads of state or government of the 27 EU member states, makes decisions using one of the most formally specified voting systems in international politics: qualified majority voting (QMV). Under QMV, a decision requires at least 55% of member states (15 out of 27) representing at least 65% of the EU population. A blocking minority requires at least four member states representing more than 35% of the population. These precise numerical thresholds make coalition mathematics directly computable.

Each member state's vote weight is fixed (determined by population), and the dual-threshold system creates a defined space of winning and blocking coalitions that can be fully enumerated. National positions on EU policy areas are extensively documented through Council working group minutes, national parliament debates, and a robust political science literature on EU voting behavior. The EURACTIV and VoteWatch Europe databases provide detailed tracking of member state positions.

The predictive modelling opportunity is enhanced by the fact that EU member states have relatively stable policy preferences along well-studied dimensions (integration vs. sovereignty, north-south fiscal policy, east-west rule-of-law tensions). These preference dimensions have been mapped by multiple academic research programs, providing calibration data that does not exist for most international bodies.

Category: Regional Governance / Supranational Decision-Making

Feasibility: High — Precisely defined QMV rules, population-weighted votes, extensive academic datasets on national preferences, VoteWatch Europe tracking.

Impact: High — EU decisions affect 450 million people across trade, regulation, foreign policy, and fiscal coordination.

Key Considerations:

- Many decisions are made by unanimity (foreign policy, taxation), where any single state can block
- The presidency rotation influences agenda-setting in ways that matter
- Franco-German coordination often pre-determines outcomes before formal voting
- The European Commission's proposal power shapes the decision space that the Council votes on

Next Steps: Integrate VoteWatch Europe data with national preference maps from Chapel Hill Expert Survey; implement the QMV calculator as a hard constraint in the simulation; model Franco-German pre-coordination as a bilateral sub-game.

Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG)

A 48-member export control regime operating by consensus, where a single member (often one) can block changes to nuclear trade rules.

The NSG coordinates export controls on nuclear and nuclear-related dual-use materials among 48 participating governments. All decisions require consensus, meaning any single member can effectively veto changes to the group's guidelines. This consensus requirement, combined with the narrow technical mandate, creates a highly structured decision environment.

The NSG's modelability comes from the fact that member positions on key issues are well-documented and relatively stable. The most prominent ongoing issue – India's membership application – has been blocked by a small number of states (primarily China, with support from a few others) for over a decade. This kind of persistent, well-defined disagreement is ideal for modelling because the positions are known, the blocking dynamics are clear, and the question reduces to whether specific states change their positions.

The group's guidelines are technical documents with specific, enumerable provisions. When amendments are proposed, the impact on each member's nuclear industry and non-proliferation commitments can be assessed. This makes it possible to construct utility functions grounded in each member's nuclear energy program, non-proliferation commitments, and bilateral relationships with nuclear-aspirant states.

Category: Non-Proliferation / Export Control

Feasibility: Medium — Consensus requirement makes blocking easy to model; however, deliberations are confidential and position data is limited.

Impact: Medium — NSG guidelines shape global nuclear trade but enforcement is national.

Key Considerations:

- Deliberations are conducted in strict confidence, limiting observational data
- China's blocking of India's membership is the dominant issue, potentially overshadowing other dynamics
- The relationship between NSG decisions and NPT obligations creates a complex legal backdrop
- Some members have minimal nuclear industries and may be influenced by alliance politics rather than technical interests

Next Steps: Map each member's nuclear energy program and non-proliferation treaty commitments; construct a bilateral-relationship matrix focusing on nuclear cooperation agreements; model consensus-blocking as a function of the least-willing member's position.

International Monetary Fund Executive Board

A 24-member board with weighted voting shares that makes lending and policy decisions through a well-defined governance structure.

The IMF Executive Board has 24 directors representing 190 member countries, with voting power weighted by financial contributions (quota shares). The largest shareholders – the US (16.5%), Japan (6.1%), China (6.1%), Germany (5.3%), France (4.0%), and the UK (4.0%) – collectively hold substantial blocking power, and the US alone can veto decisions requiring an 85% supermajority (such as quota changes or SDR allocations).

The weighted voting system makes coalition mathematics precise and computable. For ordinary decisions (simple majority of votes cast), the winning coalition calculation is straightforward. For special majority decisions (70% or 85%), the constraint space is even more tightly defined. The US veto on 85% decisions is a hard structural feature analogous to the P5 veto at the UNSC.

Lending decisions follow a documented framework (program conditionality, debt sustainability analysis) that constrains the decision space. Board members' positions can be predicted from their constituencies' economic interests, existing exposure to borrowing countries, and geopolitical alignment. The IMF publishes extensive documentation for each lending decision, including staff reports that reveal the analytical basis for decisions.

Category: International Finance / Multilateral Governance

Feasibility: High — Weighted votes are public, decision frameworks are documented, staff reports provide analytical transparency, historical precedents are extensive.

Impact: High — IMF decisions affect sovereign lending, financial stability, and economic policy conditionality globally.

Key Considerations:

- Constituency groups (where one director represents multiple countries) introduce an aggregation problem
- The Managing Director's agenda-setting power and staff recommendations heavily influence outcomes
- Geopolitical considerations (e.g., lending to Ukraine) can override the technical framework
- The board rarely votes formally – most decisions are reached by “consensus” where the chair assesses “the sense of the meeting” based on vote weights

Next Steps: Build a weighted voting model using current quota shares; calibrate director positions using published country statements and constituency composition; model the staff-recommendation influence as a Bayesian prior that directors update based on national interests.

Arctic Council

An 8-member intergovernmental forum with consensus-based decision-making, a narrow geographical mandate, and increasingly high-stakes resource and sovereignty disputes.

The Arctic Council comprises eight Arctic states (Canada, Denmark/Greenland, Finland, Iceland, Norway, Russia, Sweden, and the US) plus six indigenous Permanent Participant organizations. Decisions are made by consensus among the eight state members. The small, fixed membership and narrow geographic mandate make it an attractive modelling target.

The Council's tractability is enhanced by the fact that each member's Arctic interests are well-documented and relatively stable: territorial claims, resource extraction rights, shipping routes, indigenous rights, environmental protection, and military positioning. These interests can be mapped to specific policy positions on the Council's working groups and task forces. The biennial ministerial declarations provide a structured output that can be compared across time.

The Russia-West tension since 2022 has fundamentally altered Council dynamics, with seven members pausing cooperation with Russia. This creates an interesting modelling challenge: simulating the conditions under which normal operations might resume, or how the Council adapts to functioning as a de facto 7-member body. The binary nature of the current disruption (cooperation vs. non-cooperation with Russia) simplifies the state space considerably.

Category: Regional Governance / Environmental-Security

Feasibility: Medium — Very small membership and clear interests, but consensus-based process and current geopolitical disruption limit historical precedent for current dynamics.

Impact: Medium — Growing importance due to climate change opening Arctic resources and shipping routes.

Key Considerations:

- The current pause in Russia cooperation makes historical patterns less predictive
- Indigenous Permanent Participants have consultation rights but not decision-making power
- Observer states (including China) exert influence from outside the formal structure

- The Council has no enforcement mechanism – its outputs are declarations and guidelines, not binding law

Next Steps: Profile each member's Arctic strategy document; model the Russia cooperation/non-cooperation decision as a binary state variable linked to broader geopolitical conditions; simulate resource-access negotiations as the ice retreats.

Missile Technology Control Regime (MTCR)

A 35-member informal export control partnership with consensus decision-making and a narrow, technically defined mandate around missile proliferation.

The MTCR is an informal political understanding among 35 states to limit the proliferation of missiles and missile technology capable of delivering weapons of mass destruction. Like the NSG, it operates by consensus, but its narrower technical scope (missiles and unmanned aerial vehicles capable of delivering 500kg+ payloads to 300km+ range) makes the decision space even more constrained.

The regime's guidelines are technically specific – they categorize controlled items into Category I (complete missile systems and major subsystems, where there is a “strong presumption of denial”) and Category II (dual-use components, where case-by-case review applies). Licensing decisions follow these categories, and member positions are largely predictable from their defense industrial base, alliance commitments, and relationships with missile-aspirant states.

The MTCR's modelability is enhanced by its narrow scope: most debates center on whether specific transfers to specific countries should be permitted. The key variables – the exporting state's defense industry interests, the recipient state's missile program status, and alliance relationships – are well-documented through defense trade publications and open-source intelligence.

Category: Non-Proliferation / Arms Control

Feasibility: Medium — Technically well-defined scope, but confidential deliberations and limited public records of internal debates.

Impact: Medium — Shapes global missile proliferation but effectiveness is undermined by non-member suppliers (China, notably, is not a member).

Key Considerations:

- Deliberations are confidential with no published voting records
- The informal nature means there is no treaty text to enforce
- Members may unilaterally deviate from guidelines without formal consequences
- China and Israel are notable non-members whose behavior affects the regime's relevance

Next Steps: Map each member's missile/space launch industry and defense export portfolio; identify historical cases where transfers were debated to calibrate positions; model the consensus-blocking dynamic as a function of bilateral defense relationships with recipient states.

Organization for the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons (OPCW) Executive Council

A 41-member rotating council with regional group representation and two-thirds majority voting on key decisions related to chemical weapons compliance.

The OPCW Executive Council has 41 members elected from five regional groups for two-year terms. It oversees implementation of the Chemical Weapons Convention and makes decisions on inspections, compliance disputes, and technical cooperation. Substantive decisions require a two-thirds majority, while procedural matters need a simple majority.

The Council's modelability benefits from the narrow, technical mandate and the structured regional-group representation. Each regional group has allocated seats, and the positions of members within each group tend to cluster around shared interests (developing vs. developed country perspectives on technical assistance, alliance-based positions on compliance disputes). The high-profile Syria attribution cases demonstrated that voting patterns align closely with geopolitical blocs, making positions predictable from alliance membership.

The OPCW publishes Council decisions, reports, and meeting records that provide calibration data. The binary nature of compliance disputes (is a state party in violation or not?) creates a structured decision space. The 2018 decision to grant the OPCW attribution authority – taken by the Conference of States Parties over Russian objections – demonstrated that voting outcomes can be predicted from Cold War-legacy alliance patterns with high accuracy.

Category: Arms Control / International Law

Feasibility: Medium — Published decisions and regional-group structure aid modelling, but rotating membership requires continuous recalibration.

Impact: Medium — OPCW decisions affect chemical weapons compliance enforcement and set precedents for international accountability.

Key Considerations:

- Rotating membership means the modelling target changes every two years
- The Syria cases have become highly politicized, reducing the technical-deliberation character of the body
- Russia's opposition to attribution authority creates a persistent structural tension
- Technical secretariat recommendations strongly influence Council decisions

Next Steps: Build a regional-group preference model using historical voting data on Syria-related decisions; map rotating membership patterns to predict future Council composition; simulate compliance dispute outcomes under different membership scenarios.

International Court of Justice (ICJ)

A 15-judge international court with individually documented voting patterns, published dissents, and a structured deliberative process that maps well to agent-based simulation.

The ICJ has 15 judges elected for nine-year terms, with no two judges sharing the same nationality. Decisions are by simple majority, and every judge's vote is publicly recorded along with individual or dissenting opinions. This level of individual-level transparency is rare in international bodies and makes the ICJ exceptionally amenable to per-agent modelling.

Each judge's legal philosophy, national background, and voting history can be analyzed to construct an agent profile. Academic research has extensively documented patterns: judges from P5 countries tend to vote in favor of their home state's position, civil law tradition judges reason differently from common law tradition judges, and judges from developing countries tend to favor sovereignty-based arguments. These documented tendencies provide calibration data for agent construction.

The ICJ's deliberative process is further structured by the written and oral proceedings that precede judgment. The legal arguments presented by parties define the decision space, and the applicable legal sources (treaties, customary international law, prior ICJ decisions) constrain the reasoning. This means that simulation can incorporate both the policy preferences of judges and the legal constraints that limit the outcome space.

Category: International Law / Judicial Body

Feasibility: **High** — Individual voting records, published opinions, extensive academic analysis of judicial behavior, structured legal reasoning.

Impact: **Medium** — ICJ judgments are authoritative statements of international law but compliance is voluntary and enforcement depends on the UNSC.

Key Considerations:

- Ad hoc judges appointed for specific cases change the panel composition
- The distinction between contentious cases and advisory opinions affects voting dynamics
- Legal reasoning introduces constraints that pure policy-preference models miss
- Small sample size (a few cases per year) limits statistical calibration

Next Steps: Build individual judge profiles from voting records and published opinions; incorporate legal-reasoning constraints using NLP analysis of past judgments; simulate pending cases by assigning agent positions based on the parties' legal arguments and judge backgrounds.

Financial Action Task Force (FATF) Plenary

A 39-member body that maintains grey and black lists of jurisdictions through a peer-review evaluation process with defined criteria.

The FATF plenary brings together 39 members (37 jurisdictions and 2 regional organizations) to set anti-money laundering and counter-terrorist financing standards. Its most consequential decisions involve placing jurisdictions on the "grey list" (increased monitoring) or "black list" (high-risk, call for counter-measures) based on mutual evaluation reports. These listing decisions follow a structured methodology with 40 specific recommendations and 11 immediate outcomes that are scored.

The modelability of FATF stems from the relatively mechanical nature of listing decisions. Each evaluated jurisdiction is scored against defined criteria, and the plenary's role is to review and endorse these assessments. While political considerations can influence marginal cases, the scoring

framework provides a quantitative basis for prediction. The key modelling question becomes: for a jurisdiction on the borderline, which FATF members will push for listing and which will advocate forbearance?

Member positions on listing decisions are predictable from bilateral relationships – states with strong trade or diplomatic ties to the evaluated jurisdiction tend to argue for more lenient treatment. This creates a modelable influence network where economic and diplomatic links predict voting behavior.

Category: Financial Governance / Anti-Money Laundering

Feasibility: High — Scoring methodology is published, evaluation reports are public, listing criteria are defined, and bilateral-relationship data is available.

Impact: High — FATF grey/black listing has massive economic consequences for listed jurisdictions, affecting banking access and capital flows.

Key Considerations:

- The technical scoring framework constrains but does not fully determine listing outcomes
- Regional bodies (FSRBs) conduct evaluations for non-FATF members, adding a layer of delegation
- Turkey, Pakistan, and other politically significant states have had grey-listing influenced by geopolitical considerations
- The consensus-based decision process means even one influential member can delay listing

Next Steps: Build a scoring model from published mutual evaluation reports; construct a bilateral-relationship matrix predicting member positions on borderline cases; backtest against historical grey-list movements.

World Heritage Committee (UNESCO)

A 21-member rotating committee that makes binary inscription/non-inscription decisions based on defined criteria, with published nomination dossiers and advisory body recommendations.

The World Heritage Committee has 21 state party members elected for four-year terms from regional groups. It decides whether to inscribe nominated sites on the World Heritage List based on ten defined criteria (six cultural, four natural). Each nomination is evaluated by advisory bodies (ICOMOS for cultural sites, IUCN for natural sites) that provide formal recommendations: inscribe, refer, defer, or not inscribe.

This is a highly modelable system because the decision has a discrete outcome (inscribe or not), the criteria are published, the advisory body recommendations are public, and the committee's historical tendency to override advisory recommendations is well-documented and statistically analyzable. Research shows the committee inscribes sites against negative ICOMOS/IUCN recommendations approximately 30-40% of the time, and these overrides follow predictable patterns related to the nominating state's diplomatic influence and regional solidarity.

The committee's rotation and regional-group structure mean that the probability of inscription varies with committee composition, creating a dynamic that can be modelled as a function of which

states hold seats. Vote-trading and regional solidarity are well-documented features that make agent positions partially predictable from group membership.

Category: Cultural Governance / International Organization

Feasibility: **High** — Binary outcomes, published criteria, advisory body recommendations, complete historical records of inscription decisions and overrides.

Impact: **Low** — World Heritage inscription has symbolic and tourism-economic significance but limited hard geopolitical consequence.

Key Considerations:

- The committee frequently overrides expert advisory body recommendations, making pure criteria-based prediction insufficient
- Regional solidarity and vote-trading are endemic but difficult to observe directly
- The Danger List and delisting decisions add complexity beyond simple inscription
- Politicization of nominations (e.g., Palestine-related sites) introduces geopolitical dynamics

Next Steps: Build a historical database of nominations, advisory recommendations, and committee decisions; model override probability as a function of nominating state's diplomatic weight and committee composition; simulate inscription outcomes under different committee compositions.

International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) Board of Governors

A 35-member board with defined regional seat allocations that makes safeguards compliance decisions critical to nuclear non-proliferation.

The IAEA Board of Governors has 35 members: 13 designated by the outgoing board based on nuclear technology advancement, and 22 elected by the General Conference from regional groups. The Board makes decisions on safeguards agreements, non-compliance findings, and referrals to the UNSC. Most decisions are by simple majority, with two-thirds required for budget and certain other matters.

The Board's modelability is enhanced by the narrow nuclear mandate and the predictable alignment patterns. On non-compliance issues (Iran, North Korea, Syria historically), voting has followed a consistent East-West pattern with the Non-Aligned Movement states forming a swing bloc. The positions of major nuclear powers are stable and well-documented through years of diplomacy on nuclear issues.

What makes the Board particularly interesting for simulation is the escalation ladder: a non-compliance finding can be referred to the UNSC, creating a direct link between IAEA Board dynamics and Security Council action. Modelling this two-stage process – Board vote followed by potential UNSC action – provides a richer simulation environment than either body alone.

Category: Non-Proliferation / Nuclear Governance

Feasibility: **Medium** — Regional-group patterns and major-power positions are predictable, but rotating membership and the technical nature of safeguards findings require domain expertise.

Impact: High — Board decisions on non-compliance can trigger UNSC referrals and shape nuclear crisis diplomacy.

Key Considerations:

- The Director General’s reports significantly frame Board deliberations
- Non-Aligned Movement solidarity on nuclear issues creates a predictable bloc dynamic
- The distinction between technical safeguards findings and political judgments blurs in practice
- Iran-related decisions have consumed disproportionate Board attention, potentially biasing historical data

Next Steps: Map historical Board voting patterns on non-compliance issues by regional group; model the NAM swing-bloc dynamic; construct a two-stage simulation linking Board decisions to UNSC referral outcomes.

Codex Alimentarius Commission

A 189-member food standards body whose decisions follow an 8-step elaboration process with defined committee structures and voting thresholds, creating a highly proceduralized decision pipeline.

The Codex Alimentarius Commission, jointly run by the WHO and FAO, sets international food safety and quality standards. Despite its large membership, it is highly modelable because its standard-setting follows a rigid 8-step elaboration procedure. Each standard must pass through committee drafting, member comment rounds, and two plenary approvals. The procedural rigidity means the stage of a standard in the pipeline strongly predicts its trajectory.

The Commission’s committees are organized by subject matter (pesticide residues, food hygiene, food labelling, etc.) and by region. Within each committee, the number of actively participating delegations is typically small (20-40 for specialized committees), and positions are predictable from each country’s agricultural trade interests and regulatory capacity. The US, EU, China, and Codex host countries (various) consistently drive outcomes.

For modelling purposes, the most tractable units are the specialized committees rather than the full Commission. In committees like the Codex Committee on Pesticide Residues (CCPR), decisions on maximum residue limits (MRLs) are quantitative, the scientific basis is published by JMPR, and member positions correlate with their agricultural export profiles. This combination of quantitative outcomes and economically predictable positions makes Codex committees among the most modelable decision-making bodies in any domain.

Category: Global Health / Trade Standards

Feasibility: Medium — Rigid procedure and quantitative outcomes aid modelling, but the large membership and multiple parallel committees increase complexity.

Impact: Medium — Codex standards are referenced by WTO as the benchmark for trade disputes, giving them real trade-law consequences.

Key Considerations:

- The 8-step process means standards take years to develop, requiring long-horizon simulation

- WTO SPS Agreement references to Codex standards give them indirect legal force
- Scientific risk assessment (via JECFA, JMPR) provides a technical baseline that constrains political negotiation
- Active participation in specialized committees is much smaller than total membership

Next Steps: Focus initial modelling on a single specialized committee (CCPR recommended); map member MRL positions against agricultural trade data; model the 8-step pipeline as a staged decision process with dropout probabilities at each stage.

International Seabed Authority (ISA) Council

A 36-member council governing deep-sea mining with a unique chamber-based voting system designed to balance different interest groups.

The ISA Council has 36 members elected from four defined “chambers” representing different interest groups: major mineral consumers (Group A, 4 seats), major mineral investors (Group B, 4 seats), major mineral exporters (Group C, 4 seats), and developing states (Group D, 18 seats), plus 6 seats allocated to ensure equitable geographic representation. Substantive decisions require a two-thirds majority, and some decisions require no chamber being unanimously opposed.

This chamber-based structure is modelling gold. Each chamber represents a defined interest group with economically quantifiable preferences regarding deep-sea mining regulation – stringency of environmental standards, royalty rates, technology transfer requirements, and the Enterprise (ISA’s mining arm) provisions. The positions are predictable: mineral consumers want access and low costs, mineral exporters want protections against price competition from seabed minerals, investors want regulatory certainty, and developing states want revenue sharing and technology transfer.

The ISA is currently negotiating the Mining Code, its most consequential regulatory framework. This ongoing negotiation provides a live prediction target with clear, observable outcome variables (royalty rates, environmental standards, liability provisions). The chamber-based supermajority requirements create a tractable coalition mathematics problem.

Category: Maritime Law / Resource Governance

Feasibility: Medium — Well-defined chamber structure and economic interests, but the body is relatively new to high-stakes decisions and historical data is limited.

Impact: Medium — Potentially high if deep-sea mining becomes commercially viable; currently more regulatory-framework than operational.

Key Considerations:

- The Mining Code negotiations are the first major test of the chamber voting system for contentious issues
- Environmental concerns from civil society and some states may transcend the chamber-interest framework
- The relationship between ISA decisions and UNCLOS provisions creates legal constraints

- China's deep-sea mining ambitions make it a key player whose position affects modelling outcomes

Next Steps: Map each chamber member's economic interest profile (mineral imports/exports, seabed contract holdings); model Mining Code negotiation as a multi-dimensional bargaining problem with chamber-based voting constraints; simulate royalty rate outcomes under different environmental-stringency scenarios.

Wassenaar Arrangement Plenary

A 42-member conventional arms and dual-use technology export control regime with consensus decision-making and semi-annual review of controlled items lists.

The Wassenaar Arrangement is a multilateral export control regime for conventional arms and dual-use goods and technologies. Its 42 participating states meet in plenary to review and update the control lists (Munitions List, Dual-Use Goods and Technologies List, and Sensitive/Very Sensitive sub-lists) and exchange information on transfers and denials. All decisions require consensus.

The Arrangement's modelling value lies in its semi-annual control list review process. When a member proposes adding or removing items from the lists, each participating state's position can be predicted from its defense industrial base, technology sector, and trade relationships. States with major defense exports (US, France, UK, Germany) may resist controls that disadvantage their exporters, while states facing specific security threats may push for tighter controls on technologies relevant to those threats.

The list-review process is technically specific – proposals identify particular items by technical specifications – which means each decision has a well-defined scope. Historical list changes provide calibration data, and the technical nature of proposals limits the space of reasonable positions each state can take based on its technology profile.

Category: Arms Control / Export Controls

Feasibility: Medium — Technically defined decisions and consensus process are modelable, but deliberations are confidential.

Impact: Medium — Control list changes affect global technology trade, particularly in cybersecurity tools, electronics, and defense systems.

Key Considerations:

- Deliberations are confidential with limited public records
- Russia's participation has been contentious and may affect regime functioning
- Cyber-surveillance tools have become a flashpoint where human rights concerns intersect with export control
- The consensus requirement means single-state blocking can prevent list updates

Next Steps: Map each member's defense industrial base and technology export portfolio; identify historical list-change proposals and outcomes from open-source reporting; model consensus dynamics as a function of the most-reluctant member's technology trade interests.

Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System

A 7-member board (plus 5 rotating regional Fed presidents on the FOMC) making interest rate decisions through a structured deliberative process with published meeting transcripts, dot plots, and dissent records.

While not a geopolitical forum in the traditional sense, the Federal Open Market Committee (FOMC) – comprising 7 Fed Governors and 5 of 12 regional Federal Reserve Bank presidents – is one of the most consequential and modelable deliberative bodies in the world. It sets US interest rates through a vote at each meeting, with dissents publicly recorded and explained in meeting minutes.

The FOMC's exceptional modelability stems from the unprecedented transparency of its deliberative process. Meeting transcripts are published (with a 5-year delay), minutes are published within weeks, individual member projections (the "dot plot") are published quarterly, and speeches and congressional testimony provide continuous signals about each member's policy leanings. Each member can be placed on a hawk-dove spectrum using their public statements, and this calibration can be validated against their actual votes.

The decision space is low-dimensional (raise, hold, or cut the federal funds rate, typically in 25bp increments) and the key input variables (inflation, unemployment, GDP growth, financial conditions) are quantitatively measured and published. This makes the FOMC perhaps the single most tractable deliberative body for AI-agent simulation, where each agent's reaction function can be econometrically estimated.

Category: Monetary Policy / Economic Governance

Feasibility: High — Published transcripts, dot plots, dissent records, quantitative decision space, econometrically estimable reaction functions.

Impact: High — FOMC decisions move global financial markets and set the benchmark for the world's reserve currency.

Key Considerations:

- The Chair's consensus-building power means the vote often understates disagreement
- Forward guidance and communication policy are as consequential as rate decisions
- Balance sheet policy (quantitative easing/tightening) adds a dimension beyond rate-setting
- Political pressure on the Fed, while nominally excluded, influences the operating environment

Next Steps: Build individual member hawk-dove profiles from speeches and dot plot submissions; estimate Taylor-rule-style reaction functions for each member; simulate rate decisions under different macroeconomic scenarios.

Bank for International Settlements (BIS) Global Economy Meeting

An informal gathering of approximately 30 central bank governors that shapes global monetary policy coordination through structured but confidential discussions.

The BIS Global Economy Meeting brings together roughly 30 central bank governors from the world's most systemically important economies on a bimonthly basis. While it makes no formal decisions, it serves as the premier coordination mechanism for global monetary policy. The meeting's significance lies in the informal consensus that emerges and subsequently influences individual central bank decisions.

Despite its informality, this body is modelable because central bank policy positions are among the most transparent and data-rich in all of governance. Each participating central bank publishes policy rates, inflation targets, forward guidance, and detailed monetary policy reports. The governors' individual policy orientations are observable through their domestic policy actions and public communications. The BIS itself publishes extensive research that frames the discussions.

The modelling challenge and opportunity is to simulate how the coordination mechanism works: when Governor A signals a policy shift at the BIS meeting, how does this influence Governor B's subsequent domestic policy decision? This network-influence model is more complex than simple voting simulation but potentially more predictive of real-world outcomes because it captures the transmission mechanism of international monetary policy coordination.

Category: Monetary Policy / Central Bank Coordination

Feasibility: **Medium** — Individual central bank positions are transparent, but the meeting itself is confidential and produces no formal outputs.

Impact: **High** — The informal coordination influences monetary policy globally, affecting exchange rates, capital flows, and financial stability.

Key Considerations:

- No formal decisions or published outputs make validation difficult
- The influence mechanism (informal consensus shaping subsequent national decisions) is inherently hard to observe
- Membership is informal and the meeting is invitation-only, creating boundary uncertainty
- The relationship between BIS meeting discussions and subsequent domestic policy changes is the key causal question

Next Steps: Map each participating central bank's policy stance using published data; model the bimonthly meeting cycle as an information-exchange node in a network model; test whether post-meeting domestic policy shifts show coordination patterns beyond what bilateral channels would explain.

Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) Approval Plenaries

Line-by-line government approval sessions for Summary for Policymakers documents, where 195 countries negotiate exact wording through consensus under rigid procedural rules.

The IPCC's most modelable decision point is the approval plenary for each Summary for Policymakers (SPM). In these sessions, government delegates negotiate the exact wording of each line of the SPM text, which must be approved by consensus. The underlying scientific report is accepted

(not changed) by governments, but the SPM – the document actually read by policymakers – is negotiated word by word.

This process is remarkably tractable for simulation because the base text is provided by the scientific authors, and government interventions are constrained by a rule requiring consistency with the underlying report. This means the negotiation space is bounded: governments can soften language, add caveats, request deletions, or propose alternative formulations, but they cannot introduce claims unsupported by the scientific assessment. The positions of key blocs (oil producers seeking to soften urgency language, small island states seeking to strengthen it, major emitters seeking flexibility language) are stable and well-documented across multiple assessment cycles.

Published accounts of past approval sessions (AR5, AR6) by observers and participants provide detailed data on which delegations intervened on which paragraphs and what changes were made. The procedural constraint (consistency with underlying science) dramatically narrows the outcome space compared to unconstrained political negotiations.

Category: Climate Governance / Science-Policy Interface

Feasibility: **Medium** — Procedural constraints and stable bloc positions aid modelling, but line-by-line negotiation of text creates a high-dimensional decision space.

Impact: **High** — SPM language shapes global climate policy discourse and is referenced in UNFCCC negotiations and national policy documents.

Key Considerations:

- The “consistency with underlying report” constraint is interpreted by IPCC bureau members, introducing subjective judgment
- Marathon negotiating sessions (sometimes extending over multiple days) involve fatigue effects and package deals
- The next major approval plenary (AR7) provides a future prediction target
- The role of IPCC co-chairs in managing the process introduces a facilitator variable

Next Steps: Analyze AR6 SPM approval session records to identify intervention patterns by delegation and topic; map bloc positions (OPEC, AOSIS, EU, Umbrella Group) onto a language-strength spectrum; simulate SPM wording outcomes by modelling government interventions as constrained modifications to author-drafted text.

International Criminal Court (ICC) Pre-Trial Chambers

Three-judge panels making discrete legal decisions (arrest warrants, confirmation of charges) with individually published opinions and a structured evidentiary standard.

The ICC’s Pre-Trial Chambers consist of three-judge panels drawn from the Court’s 18 elected judges. They make binary decisions (issue/deny arrest warrants, confirm/decline charges) based on defined evidentiary standards (“reasonable grounds to believe” for warrants, “sufficient evidence to establish substantial grounds” for charge confirmation). Each judge’s vote is recorded, and dissenting opinions are published.

The chamber's modelability comes from the small panel size (3 judges), binary decision outcomes, defined legal standards, and the individual transparency of judicial reasoning. With only 18 judges total and a known assignment process, the composition of any chamber can be predicted, and each judge's legal philosophy can be profiled from their prior decisions and published opinions.

The Prosecutor's applications provide the input data – the evidence and legal arguments that define each decision's parameters. The Pre-Trial Chamber's role is to evaluate whether the Prosecutor's evidence meets the defined threshold, creating a structured assessment task that can be modelled as a signal-detection problem: given the evidence strength and each judge's threshold calibration, predict the panel decision.

Category: International Criminal Law / Judicial Body

Feasibility: High — Small panels, binary outcomes, published individual opinions, defined evidentiary standards, and profileable judges.

Impact: Medium — ICC warrant and charging decisions have major political consequences but limited enforcement capacity.

Key Considerations:

- Political context (e.g., warrants for sitting heads of state) may influence judicial reasoning in ways that deviate from strict legal analysis
- The small number of decisions (a few per year) limits statistical calibration
- Judge assignment to chambers may not be fully random, introducing selection effects
- The Prosecutor's discretion in which cases to bring shapes the universe of decisions the chamber faces

Next Steps: Build judge profiles from all published ICC Pre-Trial decisions and opinions; calibrate evidence-threshold models using historical warrant applications and outcomes; simulate pending cases based on Prosecutor filings and assigned judge profiles.

Generated by Claude (Anthropic) as part of a structured AI ideation run.